research on malaria, kalaazar, nutrition and food and drug toxicology, reproduction, immunohaematology, oncology and medical statistics. Research is also done on major metabolic diseases, occupational health and non communicable diseases.

In recent years, the ICMR is also intensifying research in non communicable diseases such as cardiovascular diseases, metabolic disorders, mental health problems, neurological disorders, blindness, liver diseases and cancer. Medical information is strengthened to meet the growing needs and demands of the community.

12.4 International Organisations

12.4.1 Food and Agricultural Organisation (FAO)

The Food and Agricultural Organisation came into existence in October 1945 with a mandate to raise levels of nutrition and standards of living, to improve agricultural productivity, and to better the conditions of rural population. By seeking to improve nutrition through nutrition-sensitive agriculture and food based approaches.

The Nutrition Division aims to:

- Create sustainable improvements in nutrition, especially among nutritionally vulnerable households and population groups.
- Provide information, assessments and analysis to combat hunger and reduce all forms of malnutrition.
- Assist countries in identifying people who are insecure and vulnerable to nutritional problems.

Besides promoting food production and food security, one of the aims of FAO is to create a world, in which all children can grow, learn and flourish, developing into healthy, active and caring members of society.

12.4.2 World Health Organisation (WHO)

World Health Organisation is an agency of the United Nations. The organization came into function on 7th April 1948 which is celebrated as World Health Day. The most important objective that WHO seeks is the attainment of the most optimum level of the health of the people which would enable them to lead a socially, economically and mentally productive life.

WHO seeks to:

- Act as a directing and coordinating authority on international health activities.
- Collobarate the member states and other agencies in planning and carrying out health programmes.
- Prompt medical research and improve the under developed countries.
- Bring the health status to international level.
- Keep communicable diseases under constant surveillance, to give knowledge about health.
- Set certain standards for the quality control of drugs, vaccines and other detrimental substances to health.

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